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المدرسة الوطنية العليا للإعلام الآلي
(المعهد الوطني للتكوين في الإعلام الآلي سابقا)
École nationale Supérieure d'Informatique



Rapport de Stage d'immersion

(Workplace Immersion)

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1. Introduction

1.1 Context and Duration

This report presents an account of an internship completed at Algérie Télécom, the national telecommunications operator of Algeria. The internship was organized as a rotation across four different departments of a wilaya branch, offering a broad view of how a large telecommunications company is structured and operated on a day-to-day basis: the Human Resources Department, the Technical / Client Support Department, the Patrimoine et Moyens (Assets and Resources) Department, and the Commercial Support Department.

1.2 Why Algérie Télécom

I chose Algérie Télécom because it is one of the biggest technology companies in Algeria, and because it has a branch in my wilaya, which made it a practical and directly relevant choice for this stage.

1.3 Personal Objectives

The objectives I set for myself for this stage were the following:

- Discover, from the inside, how a large state-owned telecommunications operator is organized and how its departments coordinate with one another.
- Understand the concrete link between the theoretical concepts studied at ESI and the day-to-day tools, procedures, and constraints of a professional IT/telecom environment.
- Get a first experience of professional conduct: observing, asking relevant questions, and communicating with company staff.

1.4 Purpose and Structure of this Report

The purpose of this internship was to observe, first-hand, how the different functions of the company interact with one another — from managing employees and company assets to resolving technical issues and supporting commercial operations — and to understand the internal procedures, tools, and platforms used to carry out this work. Each day is presented below in a dedicated section, followed by a cross-cutting analysis of what was learned and a general conclusion summarizing the main takeaways from the experience.

2. Presentation of the Host Company — Algérie Télécom

2.1 Company Profile

Algérie Télécom is Algeria's national telecommunications operator. Strategic and highly important decisions are made at the Direction Générale (General Directorate) in Algiers, which oversees the operations of branches located across the country's wilayas (provinces). The table below summarizes the company's key identifying information.

Legal status	Public economic company (EPE), organized as a joint-stock company (SPA) wholly owned by the Algerian State.
Founded	April 10, 2003, following Law n° 2000-03 of August 5, 2000, which separated postal activities from telecommunications activities in Algeria.
Sector / Activity	Telecommunications — fixed telephony, ADSL/DSL internet, and fiber-optic internet (IDOOM Fibre); Algérie Télécom is the sole operator of the fixed telephony and ADSL network in Algeria.
Size	Around 21,000 employees across the national territory.
Parent group	Subsidiary of Groupe Télécom Algérie, a public holding company created in 2017 to oversee Algeria's telecommunications operators.
Clients	Both residential and professional/business clients across Algeria, spanning several million fixed-internet subscribers.

2.2 Organizational Structure

At the local level, each wilaya has a branch of Algérie Télécom — larger wilayas may have two branches. Each branch is headed by a Director, who holds authority over the entire branch. Two services report directly to the Director: Security and Public Relations / Communication. Beneath the Director, three functional sub-directorates carry out the core work of the branch: the Support Sub-Directorate, the Technical Sub-Directorate, and the Financial Sub-Directorate. Each sub-director, in turn, oversees a number of departments that support them in carrying out their responsibilities. This structure is summarized in the table below.

Level	Description
Direction Générale	Based in Algiers; issues the company's most important strategic decisions.
Wilaya Branch	One branch per wilaya (two for the largest wilayas), implementing decisions locally.
Branch Director	Holds authority over the branch; the Security service and the PR / Communication service report directly to this position.
Sub-Directorates	Three functional sub-directorates: Support, Technical, and Financial.
Departments	Each sub-director oversees several departments that carry out the branch's daily work.

The Human Resources Department, visited on the first day of the internship, also relies on a dedicated platform called RHA, which centralizes the personal and administrative information of every employee.

2.3 Placement and Working Environment

Rather than being placed in a single fixed team, this internship rotated across four departments of the branch over four days — Human Resources, Technical / Client Support, Patrimoine et Moyens, and Commercial Support — each introduced in turn by its department head. This rotation made it possible to see how the organizational chart presented above translates into practice, and how the branch's various services depend on one another day to day.

3. Day 1 — Human Resources Department

The first day of the internship took place in the Human Resources Department (Développement des Ressources Humaines), where the department head began by presenting the organizational chart of Algérie Télécom described in Section 2, situating the Human Resources function within the wider branch structure.

3.1 The RHA Platform

The Human Resources team relies on an internal platform called RHA, which stores the personal and administrative information of every employee. This platform allows the department to quickly consult an employee's record when handling requests such as leave, transfers, or disciplinary matters.

3.2 Balancing Employee Rights and Company Interests

A recurring theme throughout the day was that the Human Resources Department's role is to protect employees' rights while also safeguarding the company's interests. This balance was illustrated by a concrete case observed during the visit: a manager came in to request vacation leave. Upon checking her record on the RHA platform, the department head saw that she had accumulated 107 days of unused vacation. He informed her that, per company policy, he could only authorize a maximum of one month of continuous leave at a time, and he also advised her to turn off her phone during that period so that she would not be disturbed by work-related matters.

3.3 Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Framework

The department head also explained that all employees are bound by an internal code of conduct that they must formally agree to. Should an employee commit a violation, the company recognizes three degrees of misconduct, each associated with a different level of disciplinary sanction, allowing the company to respond proportionally depending on the severity of the offense.

3.4 Mission Summary

Objective	Understand how the Human Resources Department organizes the branch, manages employee records, and balances employee rights against company interests.
Tools & Methods	The organizational chart; the RHA platform for centralized employee records; the company's internal code of conduct and disciplinary scale.
Difficulty & Resolution	None directly encountered — this was an observational session focused on understanding HR procedures rather than performing tasks.

4. Day 2 — Technical / Client Support Department

The second day was spent in the Technical Department, which is responsible for resolving technical problems reported by clients.

4.1 Handling Client-Reported Issues

When a customer reports a problem at a commercial service counter, the issue is logged into a dedicated internal website. It then appears on the relevant technician's dashboard, where the technician draws on their own expertise to diagnose and resolve the issue.

4.2 Connection Speed: The Most Common Issue

The majority of reported problems concern internet connection speed. When Algérie Télécom installs a line, the connection is, by default, automatically set to 16 Mbps — which is not always appropriate for the client's actual subscription. For example, a client subscribed to a 12 Mbps package will experience frequent lag and disconnections because the line is provisioned above what their equipment or plan can sustain, while a client subscribed to a 22 Mbps package will find the connection insufficient because the line is provisioned below their plan. In these cases, the technician manually adjusts the line speed to match the client's actual subscribed package.

4.3 Field Intervention

If adjusting the connection speed does not resolve the issue, the technician escalates the case by dispatching a field team to physically inspect the client's cabling and router for faults.

4.4 Network Equipment

The department head also showed the room housing the equipment responsible for the branch's internet infrastructure, most of which is supplied by Huawei.

4.5 Personal Observation

One observation from this day was that a significant portion of this diagnostic and adjustment work follows a fairly repetitive, rules-based pattern (for example, matching line speed to subscription tier) and could plausibly be automated, though the reasons this has not yet been done were not addressed during the visit.

4.6 Mission Summary

Objective	Diagnose and restore the correct internet connection speed for clients, matching the line to their actual subscribed package.
Tools & Methods	The internal client-issue ticketing website; the technician's diagnostic dashboard; manual line-speed adjustment; Huawei network equipment.
Difficulty & Resolution	When adjusting the line speed alone does not resolve the client's issue, the technician escalates by dispatching a field team to physically inspect the cabling and router.

5. Day 3 — Patrimoine et Moyens (Assets & Resources Department)

The third day was spent with the head of the Patrimoine et Moyens department, which manages the company's physical assets and material resources.

5.1 Company Vehicle Fleet

The department head began by showing the company's fleet of vehicles, which falls under this department's responsibility.

5.2 Procurement Procedure

He then explained the step-by-step procedure followed whenever the company needs to purchase equipment or supplies:

1. A purchase request is written and submitted to the Financial Department.
2. Once the Financial Department approves the request, it is forwarded to the Director for final approval.
3. Once approved, the purchase is made from suppliers with which Algérie Télécom has an established relationship.
4. Upon delivery, the equipment is inspected by the department.
5. Payment is handled according to value: low-value purchases are paid directly, while high-value purchases are settled by check.

5.3 Asset Tagging and Inventory Database

Once a purchased item is received, a sticker bearing the product's name and a barcode is generated and affixed to it. The item is then scanned and entered into the company's database, which tracks which room each item is located in.

5.4 Annual Inventory Audit

At the end of each year, the department carries out a full inventory count to verify that all recorded assets are accounted for. If discrepancies are found involving high-value items, the matter is escalated through formal legal / judicial procedures.

5.5 Mission Summary

Objective	Ensure that company purchases and physical assets are properly authorized, tracked, and accounted for throughout their lifecycle.
Tools & Methods	Written purchase requests and a multi-level approval chain (Financial Department, then Director); established supplier relationships; barcode tagging and an inventory database.
Difficulty & Resolution	When the annual inventory reveals discrepancies in high-value items, the

	matter is resolved by escalating it through formal legal / judicial procedures.
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6. Day 4 — Commercial Support Department

The final day of the internship was spent in the Commercial Support service, staffed by computer science engineers whose role is to support the company's commercial services.

6.1 Supporting Commercial Services

Client-related issues raised by commercial services pass through a series of dedicated internal platforms — BSS, IM, OM, and WFR. An issue is only considered resolved once it has cleared all of these systems.

6.2 The "Wave" Procedure

This service holds a unique privilege within the company: its engineers are the only staff authorized to withdraw products from stock without payment. Normally, when an agent issues a router to a client, they must enter a payment into the system. However, if a client's router malfunctions while still under warranty and needs to be replaced, the agent cannot simply issue a free replacement themselves — they must send an email to the Commercial Support service, which can release a replacement router at no cost. This procedure is referred to internally as "wave."

6.3 Subscription Migration Handling

The service is also responsible for handling subscription changes. For instance, if a client who subscribed to a 30-day DSL plan switches to a fiber optic plan before the DSL cycle ends, this service credits the client with the remaining unused days from the previous subscription.

6.4 Reporting Function

In addition to technical support, this service generates reports that support the work of other departments — for example, figures on monthly revenue and sales volumes.

6.5 Mission Summary

Objective	Support commercial services by resolving client issues across multiple internal systems and handling stock or subscription exceptions that regular agents cannot process themselves.
Tools & Methods	The BSS, IM, OM, and WFR platforms; an email-based escalation process for the "wave" procedure.
Difficulty & Resolution	Regular agents cannot issue a free replacement router even when a client's warranty is valid, since doing so normally requires a payment entry into the system. This is resolved by escalating the request by email to the Commercial Support service, which can release the equipment at no cost (the "wave" procedure).

7. Analysis, Learnings and Difficulties

7.1 Technical, Organizational and Human Learnings

On the technical side, this internship provided a concrete look at how everyday connectivity issues are actually diagnosed and resolved — from matching a line's provisioned speed to a client's subscription, to escalating unresolved cases to a field team. On the organizational side, seeing four departments in succession made clear how a large state-owned operator distributes responsibility: strategic decisions flow down from the Direction Générale, while each department — Human Resources, Technical, Patrimoine et Moyens, and Commercial Support — operates its own procedures and platforms while remaining dependent on the others. On the human side, the internship offered a first exposure to how professional staff explain their own work to a newcomer and manage requests from colleagues and clients, whether it is an HR manager approving leave or a Commercial Support engineer processing an email request from another team.

7.2 Difficulties Encountered

One of the main difficulties I faced was my limited background in networks and hardware, which left me a little behind when it came to fully understanding certain topics. Algérie Télécom is a highly technical company, and this gap made it somewhat hard to follow everything the engineers explained, particularly during the more technical sessions.

7.3 Soft Skills Mobilized

This stage helped me build several soft skills. I learned to speak up and communicate in the professional world without the fear I initially had about it. I also learned the importance of active listening: while I was in the Patrimoine et Moyens department, the department director took a phone call, and once he finished, he asked me which department the call concerned — I did not know. He told me that I should have listened carefully enough to figure that out for myself, which was a valuable lesson in paying close attention rather than simply being present. That same moment also taught me not to be shy about asking questions, whether of my tuteur or of other staff in administrative offices.

7.4 Personal Reflection

Beyond the specific procedures observed in each department, the internship highlighted how interconnected these functions are: a decision made by the Human Resources Department, a technical adjustment in the field, a purchase processed by Patrimoine et Moyens, or a report generated by Commercial Support all ultimately serve the same goal of keeping the company running smoothly and its clients satisfied. The recurring observation that certain repetitive technical tasks — such as matching line speed to subscription tier — could plausibly be automated stood out as a genuine point of critical reflection on how such organizations might evolve, and is a useful reminder that observation, not just hands-on work, can produce real analytical insight.

8. Conclusion

8.1 Were the Objectives Met?

By the end of the stage, I managed to meet all of the objectives I set out in Section 1.3.

8.2 What This Experience Added

This internship at Algérie Télécom provided a well-rounded view of how a large telecommunications company operates behind the scenes. Rotating through the Human Resources, Technical, Patrimoine et Moyens, and Commercial Support departments made it possible to see how strategic decisions made at the Direction Générale are implemented locally, how employee rights are balanced against company interests, how technical issues are diagnosed and resolved, how company assets are procured and tracked, and how commercial and technical support services coordinate with one another.

8.3 A Shift in Perspective

What shifted the most for me was realizing that coding and computers make up only a small part of the work — around 30% — even in a technical company like this one. Most of the work is actually about communicating: explaining problems clearly, coordinating between departments, and talking with clients and colleagues.

8.4 Ideas for Improvement

- Automating repetitive, rules-based technical tasks — such as matching a client's line speed to their subscribed package — to free up technician time for more complex cases.
- I noticed that the internal websites used by several departments involve a lot of repetitive manual work; adding automation directly into the website's code for these repetitive steps could save considerable time for the engineers.